Discuss and Possibly Adopt Revisions to Board Policy FFB (Local)

Recommendation:
That the Board of Trustees adopt updated Local Board Policy FFB Student Welfare: Crisis Intervention

Explanation:
The Administration recommended revisions to Board Policy FFB Student Welfare: Crisis Intervention. The Administration recommends that the updated Local Board Policy FFB be adopted as presented.

Policy Reference: FFB Local

Recommended by:

Dr. Ted Landry
Interim Superintendent of Schools

Threat Assessment And Safe And Supportive Team

In compliance with law, the Superintendent shall ensure that a multidisciplinary threat assessment and safe and supportive team is established to serve each campus. The Superintendent shall appoint team members. The Superintendent of the district shall ensure, to the greatest extent practicable, that the members appointed to each team have expertise in counseling, behavior management, mental health and substance use, classroom instruction, special education, school administration, school safety and security, emergency management, and law enforcement. The team shall be responsible for developing and implementing a safe and supportive school program at each campus served by the team and shall support the District in implementing its multi-hazard emergency operations plan.

Training

Each team shall complete training provided by an approved provider on evidence-based threat assessment programs.

Student Reports

Each campus shall establish a clear procedure for a student to report concerning behavior exhibited by another student for assessment by the team or other appropriate District employee.

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Employee Confidentiality

A District employee who reports a potential threat may elect for the employee's identity to remain confidential and not be subject to disclosure under the state's public information law. The employee's identity shall only be revealed when necessary for the team, the District, or law enforcement to investigate the reported threat.

The District shall maintain a record of the identity of a District employee who elects for the employee's identity to remain confidential.

Imminent Threats Or Emergencies

A member of the team or any District employee may act immediately to prevent an imminent threat or respond to an emergency, including contacting law enforcement directly.

Threat Assessment Process

The District shall develop procedures as recommended by the Texas School Safety Center. In accordance with those procedures and Education Code 37, the threat assessment and safe and supportive team shall conduct threat assessments using a process that includes:

1. Identifying individuals, based on referrals, tips, or observations, whose behavior has raised concerns due to threats of violence or exhibition of behavior that is harmful, threatening, or violent.
2. Before an assessment takes place:
    a. Notifying the parent of or person standing in parental relation to the student regarding the assessment.
    b. Providing an opportunity for the parent of or person standing in parental relation to the student to participate in the assessment, either in person or remotely.
    c. Providing an opportunity for the parent of or person standing in parental relation to the student to submit to the team information regarding the student.
3. Conducting an individualized assessment based on reasonably available information to determine whether the individual poses a threat of violence or poses a risk of harm to self or others and the level of risk.
4. After completing a threat assessment of a student, providing to the parent of or person standing in parental relation to the student the team's findings and conclusions regarding the student.
5. Implementing appropriate intervention and monitoring strategies, if the team determines an individual poses a threat of harm to self or others. These strategies may include referral of a student for a mental health assessment and escalation procedures as appropriate.

For a student or other individual the team determines poses a serious risk of violence to self or others, the team shall immediately report to the Superintendent, who shall immediately attempt to contact the student's parent or guardian. Additionally, the Superintendent shall coordinate with law enforcement

authorities as necessary and take other appropriate action in accordance with the District's multihazard emergency operations plan.

For a student the team identifies as at risk of suicide, the team shall follow the District's suicide prevention program. If the student at risk of suicide also makes a threat of violence to others, the team shall conduct a threat assessment in addition to actions taken in accordance with the district's suicide prevention program.

For a student the team identifies as using or possessing tobacco, drugs, or alcohol ~~having a substance abuse issue~~, the team shall follow the District's substance abuse program.

For a student whose conduct may constitute a violation of the District's Student Code of Conduct, the team shall make a referral to the campus behavior coordinator or other appropriate administrator to consider disciplinary action.

As appropriate, the team may refer a student:

1. To a local mental health authority or health-care provider for evaluation or treatment; or
2. For a full individualized and initial evaluation for special education services.

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The team shall not provide any mental health-care services, except as permitted by law.

Guidance To School Community

The team shall provide guidance to students and District employees on recognizing harmful, threatening, or violent behavior that may pose a threat to another person, the campus, or the community and methods to report such behavior to the team, including through anonymous reporting.

Reports

The team shall provide reports to the Texas Education Agency as required by law.